Dealflow

USER GUIDE

Self-hosting and install

Business development CRM

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Self-hosting and install

This page is for the person who runs the Dealflow server. Dealflow is self-hosted and single-company: one install serves one company, and your data stays on your own machine.

The full technical references are `docs/deploy.md` and `docs/reverse-proxy.md` in the repository. This page is the short version.

What you need

- A Linux server with Docker and the Docker Compose plugin.
- A domain for the app (for example `crm.example.com`) and a second one for file storage (for example `s3.crm.example.com`), both pointing at the server.
- A reverse proxy that handles HTTPS (for example Caddy or nginx). Dealflow does not include one.
- An SMTP account for the emails Dealflow sends (sign-in links, invites, notifications, quotes).
- Optionally, an OpenRouter API key for the AI features.

What runs

Service	What it does
`app`	The Dealflow web app
`ws`	Live updates in the browser
`worker`	Background jobs: mail sync, scheduled email, automations, reminders, backups
`postgres`	The database
`minio`	File storage (attachments, imports, photos)
`migrate`	Runs once on each start to update the database

How to install

1. Get the code onto the server and copy the example settings:

```
cp .env.example .env
```

2. Fill in `.env`. The values that matter most:

Setting	What to put
`BASE_URL`	Your app address, for example `https://crm.example.com`
`NEXT_PUBLIC_WS_URL`	`wss://crm.example.com/_ws`
`MINIO_ENDPOINT`	Your storage address, for example `https://s3.crm.example.com`
`SEED_ADMIN_EMAIL`	The email of the first admin
`SMTP_HOST`, `SMTP_PORT`, `SMTP_SECURE`, `SMTP_USER`, `SMTP_PASS`, `SMTP_FROM`	Your outgoing mail account
`OPENROUTER_API_KEY`, `OPENROUTER_MODEL`	Your AI key and model (leave the key empty to run without AI)
`BASE_CURRENCY`	Your company currency, for example `GBP`

3. Generate the secrets:

```
openssl rand -base64 32   # TOKEN_ENCRYPTION_KEY
openssl rand -hex 32      # WS_TICKET_SECRET
openssl rand -hex 16      # MINIO_ACCESS_KEY and MINIO_SECRET_KEY
```

4. Start everything:

```
docker compose up -d --build
```

5. Point your reverse proxy at the three routes below, then check the app is healthy:

```
curl -fsS https://crm.example.com/api/health
```

Result: `{"ok":true}`.

Reverse proxy routes

Public address	Send to	Notes
`https://crm.example.com`	`127.0.0.1:3000`	The app, including `/api/*`
`https://crm.example.com/_ws`	`127.0.0.1:8080`	Live updates (WebSocket). Forward the path and query unchanged.
`https://s3.crm.example.com`	`127.0.0.1:9000`	File uploads and downloads. Must match `MINIO_ENDPOINT` exactly.

Keep the app, ws and storage ports bound to `127.0.0.1` so only your proxy can reach them. A working Caddy example is in `docs/reverse-proxy.md`.

How to sign in the first time

1. Go to your app address, choose **Email link**, and enter the `SEED_ADMIN_EMAIL` address.
2. Open the link in the email and set a password.

If email is not working yet, create a one-time admin link on the server instead:

```
docker compose exec app node dist/bootstrap-link.mjs
```

Then invite everyone else from **Settings › Users** (see Admin).

How to update

```
git pull
docker compose up -d --build
```

Database changes are applied automatically before the app restarts.

Backups and restore

Dealflow makes a daily backup of the database and a copy of stored files, kept for a set number of days. Settings: `BACKUP_ENABLED`, `BACKUP_DIR` and `BACKUP_KEEP`. Admins can see the status and run an extra backup in **Settings › Backups**.

To restore, on the server, with the app stopped:

```
docker compose stop app worker ws
docker compose run --rm -v ./backups:/restore worker \
  node dist/backup-restore.mjs /restore/{backup file name}.tar.gz --files --yes
docker compose start app worker ws
```

Without `--files` only the database is restored. Copy the backup folder somewhere off the server too, so a disk failure cannot take both.

Logs

```
docker compose logs -f app      # or ws, worker
```

Privacy defaults

Usage telemetry and the update check are off by default (`DISABLE_TELEMETRY=true`, `DISABLE_UPDATE_CHECK=true`). Nothing is sent anywhere unless you turn it on, apart from the services you configure: your mail server, your AI provider, and any enrichment provider an admin enables.